MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-BVOC (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION April 2026

SECOND SEMESTER

Skill Development Components (SDC) – MG2SDCBAJ102 – PRINT MEDIA PRODUCTION

(2025 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate€, Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) And Appreciation(Ap)

Part A – MCQ

Answer all questions

Each question carries 1 mark

1. A government implementing a new law is an example of:

a) Hard news
b) Soft news
c) Lifestyle story
d) Feature article

Answer: a) Hard news

2. The first Indian language book was printed in:

a) Hindi
b) Tamil
c) Bengali
d) Sanskrit

Answer: b) Tamil

3. Select the term for the part of a news story that editors often trim first to save space.

a) Introduction
b) Body
c) Lead
d) Conclusion

Answer: d) Conclusion

4. Identify the option that is NOT considered a requirement of news.

a) Human involvement
b) Emotional or physical interest
c) Prior publication
d) Factual information

Answer: c) Prior publication

5. Handling defamation cases comes under the:

a) PR Department
b) Legal Department
c) Advertising Department
d) Editorial Department

Answer: b) Legal Department

6. Giving the largest headline and prominent position to the most important story illustrates:

a) Unity
b) Hierarchy
c) Consistency
d) Alignment

Answer: b) Hierarchy

7. The sub-editor is often called the:

a) Public face of the newspaper
b) Unsung hero of the newsroom
c) Business head
d) Legal advisor

Answer: b) Unsung hero of the newsroom

8. The first illustrated magazine was:

a) The Illustrated London News
b) The Spectator
c) The Review
d) The Gentleman's Magazine

Answer: a) The Illustrated London News

9. The word "magazine" is derived from an Arabic word meaning:

a) Newspaper
b) Storehouse
c) Journal
d) Book

Answer: b) Storehouse

10. The print medium using high-quality paper and intended for repeated reading is:

a) Magazines
b) Newspapers
c) Flyer
d) Circular

Answer: a) Magazines

Part B – Short Essay Questions

Answer any 10 questions

Each question carries 2 marks

11. Define the sports page and state two types of information it provides.

Answer:
The sports page is the section of a newspaper dedicated to sports news and events. It provides:

- Match scores and results
- Player interviews and sports analysis

12. Define accuracy in news editing and state its importance.

Answer:
Accuracy in news editing means ensuring that all facts, names, dates, and details are correct.
Importance:

- Maintains credibility of the newspaper
- Prevents misinformation and legal problems

13. Distinguish between Staff Reporter and Stringer.

Answer:

Staff Reporter	Stringer
Permanent employee	Freelance contributor
Receives monthly salary	Paid per report
Works full-time	Works occasionally

14. Describe woodblock printing and its limitations.

Answer:
Woodblock printing is a printing method in which text or images are carved on wooden blocks and printed using ink.
Limitations:

- Time-consuming process
- Wooden blocks wear out quickly

15. Describe how prominence affects the newsworthiness of an event.

Answer:
Prominence refers to the importance or fame of people involved in an event. Events involving famous personalities or leaders become more newsworthy because people show greater interest in them.

16. Give any two examples of broadsheet newspapers.

Answer:

- The Hindu
- Malayala Manorama

17. Explain the importance of newspapers as a textual medium.

Answer:
Newspapers are important because they:

- Provide detailed information and analysis
- Educate and inform the public
- Preserve records of events

18. Identify two roles of magazines in shaping lifestyle and public opinion.

Answer:

- Influence fashion, health, and lifestyle trends
- Create awareness about social and political issues

19. Point out two subjects commonly found in men's magazines.

Answer:

- Sports and fitness
- Technology and automobiles

20. Mention two features that made Malayalam magazines popular among readers.

Answer:

- Simple and attractive language
- Serialized stories and illustrations

21. Identify two characteristics of imaginative writing.

Answer:

- Creativity and originality
- Use of descriptive and expressive language

22. Outline the purpose of a folio in magazine design.

Answer:
A folio provides page numbers, publication name, and issue details to help readers navigate the magazine easily.

23. Explain how QuarkXPress helps in page design.

Answer:
QuarkXPress helps in:

- Designing page layouts
- Arranging text, images, and typography professionally

24. Explain the role of Balarama in promoting reading habits among children.

Answer:
Balarama promotes reading habits by providing:

- Entertaining stories and comics
- Educational puzzles and activities for children

25. Explain the purpose of content planning in magazines.

Answer:
Content planning helps:

- Organize articles and visuals properly
- Maintain balance and consistency in magazine production

Part C – Essay Questions

Answer any 5 questions

Each question carries 5 marks

26. Classify Malayalam newspapers based on their political affiliations.

Answer:
Malayalam newspapers can be classified according to their political affiliations:

1. Communist-oriented newspapers
    - Example: *Deshabhimani*
2. Congress-oriented newspapers

    - Example: *Veekshanam*
3. Independent newspapers
    - Examples: *Malayala Manorama*, *Mathrubhumi*

Political affiliation influences editorial policy and presentation of news.

27. Explain different types of headline.

Answer:
Different types of headlines are:

1. Banner Headline – Large headline across the page
2. Flush Left Headline – Aligned to the left side
3. Flush Right Headline – Aligned to the Right side
4. Crossline Headline – Single line across the column
5. Inverted Pyramid Headline – Descending style arrangement
6. Skyline Headline - A skyline headline is a headline placed above the newspaper's nameplate to highlight very important news.

Headlines help attract readers and summarize news stories.

28. Explain the importance of headline in a news story.

Answer:
Headlines are important because they:

- Attract reader attention
- Summarize the main idea quickly
- Indicate importance of the news
- Improve readability and page design
- Encourage readers to read the full story

29. Explain the key components and contents of the editorial page.

Answer:
The editorial page includes:

- Editorial articles
- Letters to the editor
- Opinion columns
- Editorial cartoons

Functions:

- Express the newspaper's viewpoint
- Encourage public discussion

- Provide analysis of current issues

30. Describe all types of newspaper layouts and their features.

Answer:

Static Layout

A fixed and traditional layout where news items appear in the same positions daily. It provides consistency and easy navigation.

2. Dynamic Layout

A flexible layout where positions of headlines, photos, and stories change according to news importance. It gives a modern and lively appearance.

4. Modular Layout

A layout using rectangular blocks called modules for each story. It is neat, organized, and reader-friendly.

5. Irregular Layout

A creative layout using unconventional shapes and arrangements. It gives strong visual appeal but may reduce readability.

6. Vertical Layout

A traditional layout arranging stories in vertical columns from top to bottom. It is simple but may appear monotonous.

7. Horizontal Layout

A layout emphasizing horizontal arrangement with multi-column headlines and wide visuals. It creates strong visual impact and balance.

31. Explain the functions of the Editor-in-Chief, Magazine Editor, Designers, and Editorial Assistants in ensuring quality publication.

Answer:

- **Editor-in-Chief:** Supervises editorial policy and overall publication quality
- **Magazine Editor:** Selects and edits content
- **Designers:** Prepare layouts, typography, and visuals

- **Editorial Assistants:** Assist in proofreading and coordination

Together they ensure accuracy and attractive publication.

32. Describe the four major components of a magazine, explaining their purpose.

Answer:

1. Cover Story :Main highlighted story that attracts readers.
2. Editorial : Editor's opinion on important issues.
3. Articles : Informative nonfiction writings on specific topics.
4. Features : Detailed and interesting human interest stories.

33. Explain the characteristics of effective magazine writing.

Answer:
Characteristics include:

- Clear and simple language
- Reader-friendly style
- Creative presentation
- Attractive introduction
- Proper structure and flow
- Informative and engaging content

Part D – Long Essay Questions

Answer any 1 question

Each question carries 15 marks

34. Differentiate and explain headlines, subheads, body copy, pull quotes, and image captions with examples of their usage in magazine production.

Answer:

Headlines

The main title of an article used to attract readers.
Example: "Climate Change and Kerala Floods"

Subheads

Secondary headings that divide the article into sections.
Example: “Causes of Flooding”

Body Copy

The main written content of the article containing detailed information.

Pull Quotes

Important quotations highlighted separately for emphasis.
Example: “We must act now to protect nature.”

Image Captions

Short descriptions given below photographs explaining the image.
Example: “Rescue operations during Kerala floods.”

Difference:

- Headlines summarize the topic
- Subheads organize content
- Body copy gives detailed information
- Pull quotes emphasize key statements
- Captions explain photographs

These elements improve readability and visual appeal.

35. Describe the essential elements of the front page of a newspaper and explain their functions.

Answer:

Essential elements of a newspaper front page are:

1. Nameplate/Masthead – Shows newspaper identity
2. Headlines – Attract readers to important stories
3. Lead Story – Main news of the day
4. Photographs – Provide visual appeal
5. Captions – Explain photographs
6. Byline – Shows reporter’s name
7. Dateline – Indicates place and date
8. Index – Guides readers to inside pages
9. Advertisements – Provide revenue
10. Folio – Contains page number and edition details

Functions:

- Inform readers quickly
- Improve presentation
- Highlight major events
- Help navigation

36. Explain the major functions of a newspaper, including how it informs, educates, entertains, and influences readers, with examples from daily life.

Answer:

Informing

Newspapers provide current information on politics, economy, sports, weather, and international events.
Example: Election news and traffic updates.

Educating

They spread knowledge through editorials, educational supplements, and awareness articles.
Example: Health awareness campaigns.

Entertaining

Newspapers entertain readers through comics, puzzles, cinema pages, and feature articles.
Example: Weekend supplements and cartoons.

Influencing Public Opinion

Editorials and opinion columns influence people's attitudes toward social and political issues.
Example: Campaigns against corruption and drug abuse.

Additional Functions

- Advertising products and services
- Providing job information
- Preserving historical records

Thus, newspapers play an important role in informing, educating, entertaining, and influencing society.